

The Guide

Every screen, what it is for, and what to put in it.

Release 1.4.8 · 28 September 2026 · Screenshots from a demonstration account

1. What this is, in one page

PingPulse answers your WhatsApp. A customer messages the number your business already uses, and it replies — with your prices, your stock, your opening hours and your way of writing — then puts that person on a board so you can see where the sale stands.

It is not a chatbot with a script. Everything it says comes from what you load into it, and there is a short list of things it is not allowed to do no matter how the conversation goes. The most important is this one:

It will never tell a customer that something happened unless it actually happened. Not a booking, not a callback, not a price. If it cannot confirm it, it says so or it hands the conversation to you.

That rule is enforced in the software, not in the agent's instructions, which is the difference between a promise and a setting.

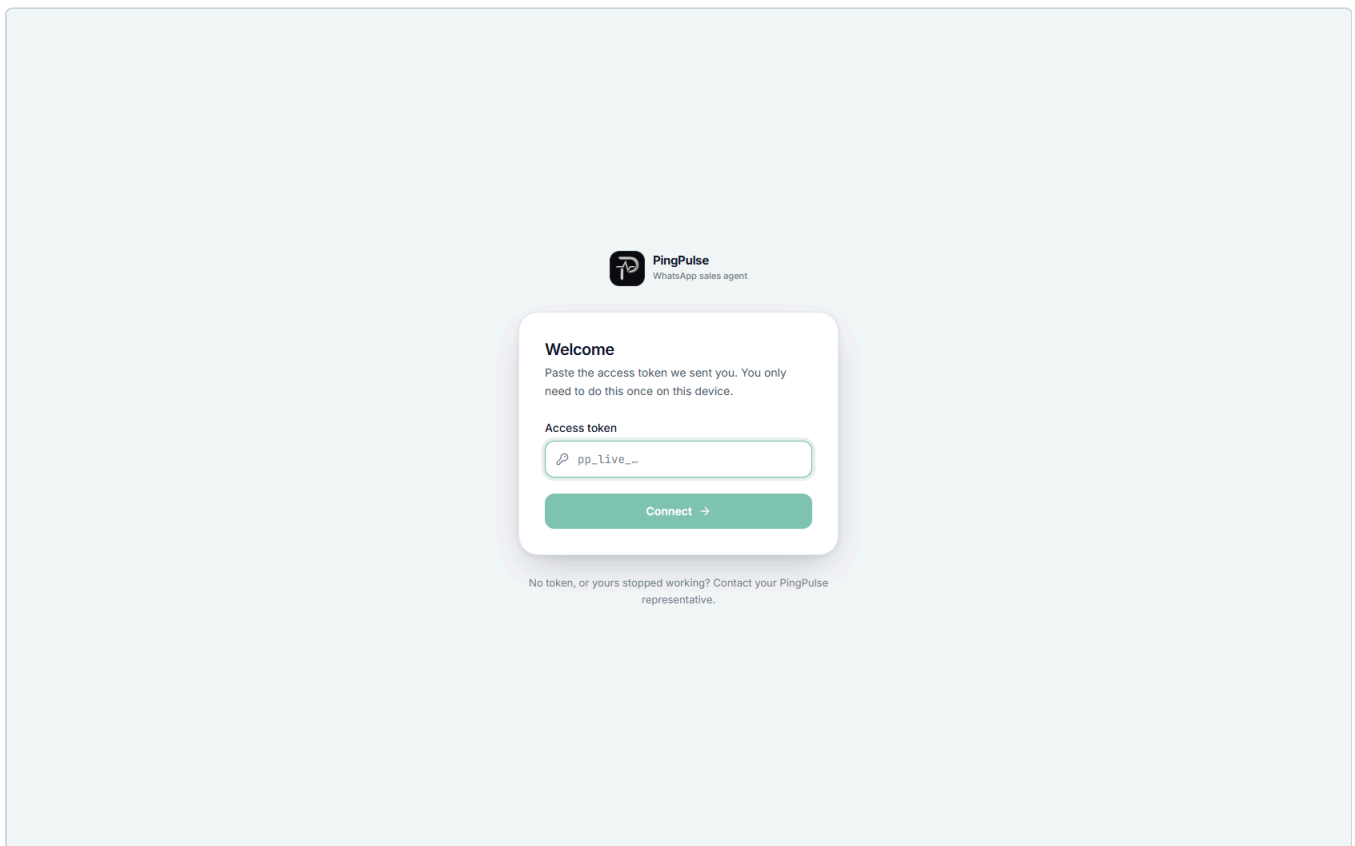
There are two ways to use it. The **desktop app** installs on Windows and updates itself. The **browser dashboard** is the same thing at <https://pingpulse.duckdns.org/app/> — nothing to install, works on a phone. Use either, or both; they show the same data.

2. What you give, and what you get

Setting up takes about twenty minutes, and most of it is finding files you already have.

You give us	Why it is needed	What we do with it
Your business name, what you sell, and your currency	Everything the agent says starts here	Becomes the agent's understanding of who it is speaking for
Your timezone	Times are stored against it	Every hour you state, and every appointment offered, is read in your zone
A WhatsApp number	The number customers message	We connect it — scan a QR with the phone that owns it, or use your own Twilio account
Your price list, catalogue or brochure — PDF, Word, Excel, images	The agent is forbidden from inventing a price	We read it, and it quotes only what is in there
Your opening hours	Appointments are only offered inside them	Booking switches on, and nothing is offered at 2am
An email address or phone for alerts	So you are told when you are needed	Alerts reach a person instead of going nowhere
<i>Optional:</i> past replies you have written	So it sounds like you	We draft a description of your voice and show it to you before anything changes
We give you	What it means	
An agent that answers day and night	It never sleeps, and it never invents a price	
A live inbox	Every conversation, as it happens, with the agent's replies marked as the agent's	
A board	Every customer on it, with the stage they are at, in your own words	
Real booking	Appointments taken only inside your hours, written down, and sent to your phone's calendar	
Alerts	When someone asks for a person, or when something breaks	
Numbers	How many, how fast, where people stop replying	
A sandbox	Try any message against the real agent, with nothing sent	
Your keys, your account	No lock-in on the AI provider — bring your own keys	

3. Signing in



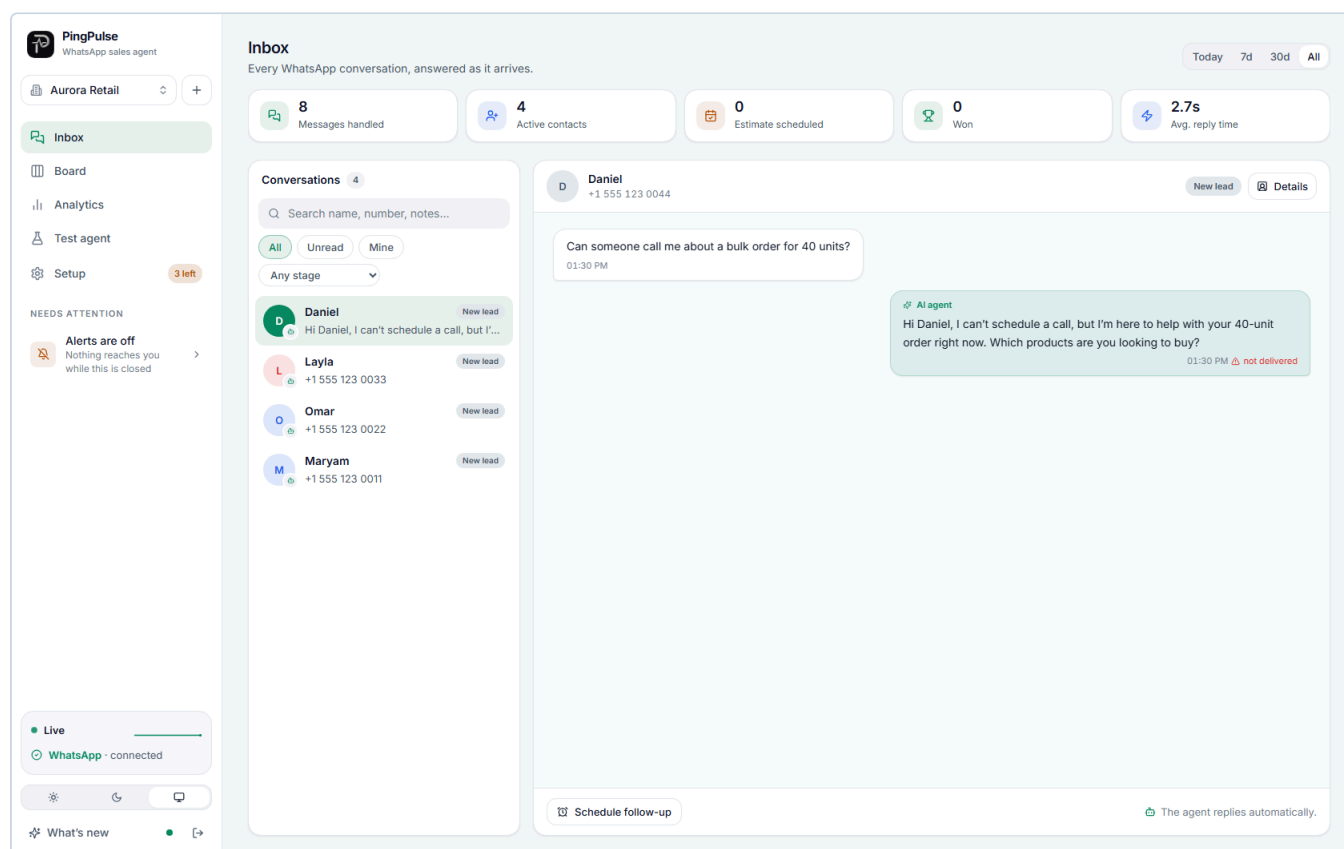
The sign-in screen. One token, pasted once.

Purpose. There are no passwords and no sign-up. We send you one access token; you paste it once and the app remembers it.

How you use it. Paste and press **Connect**. That is the whole login.

Worth knowing. A licence covers one person and their team, counted by device. If you replace a machine, or run out of seats, ask us to reset them. If the token ever stops working, contact us rather than trying another — a wrong token will not do any damage, but it will not get you in either.

4. The screen you will live in



The workspace: numbers across the top, conversations on the left, the pipeline on the right.

Three areas, and they do not move:

- **Across the top** — how many messages were handled, how many people are active, how many are booked, how many won, and how fast they were answered. Pick **Today**, **7 days**, **30 days** or **All time**; every number obeys the choice. A dash means *no answer yet*, not zero — nought out of nought leads is not a nought per cent conversion rate, it is a question that has not been asked enough times.
- **In the middle** — every conversation. Search by name, number, company or notes; filter by stage, unread, or the ones you have taken over. Pick one and it opens beside the list.
- **Down the left** — **Inbox**, **Board**, **Analytics**, **Test agent** and **Setup**. Anything that needs you appears underneath them under *Needs attention*, and **Setup** carries a count of what is still outstanding.

The business selector sits at the top of that sidebar; if you run more than one, switching it moves everything on the screen with it. At the bottom are your connection light, your name, **What's new**, and a switch for light, dark or whatever your computer is set to.

Click your name to open your **profile**: the name your access token was issued to, the token itself — hidden until you press the eye, with a button to copy it — and the date it is valid until. It is there for the day you sign in on another computer. Keep it private: anyone who has it can open your dashboard, and each computer uses one of your licence's seats.

5. Setting up, step by step

Setup lists ten steps in three groups, most important first:

- **Required — your agent cannot start without these.** Your business, prices and knowledge, where you are, and connecting WhatsApp. Until all four are done the inbox, board and analytics stay locked, and PingPulse tells you so each time you come in, with the steps still open. **Test agent** opens as soon as your business and prices are in, so you can try it before any customer can reach it.
- **Recommended — it runs without these, but something is missing.** Hours and booking, alerts, and the calendar. Without hours the agent cannot book anything: every booking request is handed to a team member instead.
- **Optional — fine to leave as they are.** Your board, learning and problems.

The steps can be done in any order. Start with whichever you have to hand — uploading a price list before writing the description is fine. If your access token came without a business attached, opening any step creates it, named after you, and **Your business** is where you rename it. WhatsApp is listed last among the required steps on purpose: the moment it connects, customers start getting answers, so it is best connected once the rest is in place.

Each step states what it is for and what happens if you skip it. The ticks are read from the real system, so a step cannot be marked done just by visiting it, and a business you set up on another machine already shows as done here.

If your WhatsApp phone goes offline later, nothing locks. The inbox stays open and a red **WhatsApp is offline** warning appears until it reconnects.

Step 1 — Your business (required)

The screenshot shows the PingPulse 'Setup' screen for a WhatsApp sales agent named 'Aurora Retail'. The interface is divided into three main sections: a left sidebar, a central 'Setup' list, and a large right-hand form.

- Left Sidebar:** Contains navigation links for 'Inbox', 'Board', 'Analytics', 'Test agent', and 'Setup' (which is highlighted with a green bar and '3 left' items). Below these is a 'NEEDS ATTENTION' section with a warning icon and text: 'Alerts are off. Nothing reaches you while this is closed.' At the bottom, there's a 'Live' status indicator and a 'WhatsApp - connected' status.
- Central Setup List:** A vertical list of steps numbered 1 to 8. Steps 1, 2, and 3 are marked with green checkmarks, indicating they are completed. Steps 4 through 8 are marked with orange circles and have 'optional' labels next to them. The steps are: 1. Your business, 2. Connect WhatsApp, 3. Prices and knowledge, 4. Hours and booking, 5. Alerts, 6. Your board, 7. Learning, and 8. Problems.
- Right-hand Form:** The 'Your business' step is selected, showing a detailed form. It includes a warning: 'Everything the agent says starts here. Without it, it has nothing to work from.' and a note: 'If you skip this: The agent answers with no idea what you sell.' The form fields include: 'Business name' (filled with 'Aurora Retail'), 'How should it sound?' (filled with 'Warm, quick and practical. Talks like someone on the shop floor who knows the stock, gives a str'), 'What you sell' (filled with a product catalogue for 'Aurora SoundPods Pro' and 'Aurora SoundPods Lite'), 'Currency' (set to 'AED'), 'Replies in' (set to 'English'), and 'WHERE YOU ARE' (set to 'Choose your timezone...'). A 'How it should sell' section contains a text box with a description of the agent's role. At the bottom of the form is a green 'Save' button and a 'Next: Connect WhatsApp' button.

Step one: the name, what you sell and how the agent should sell it.

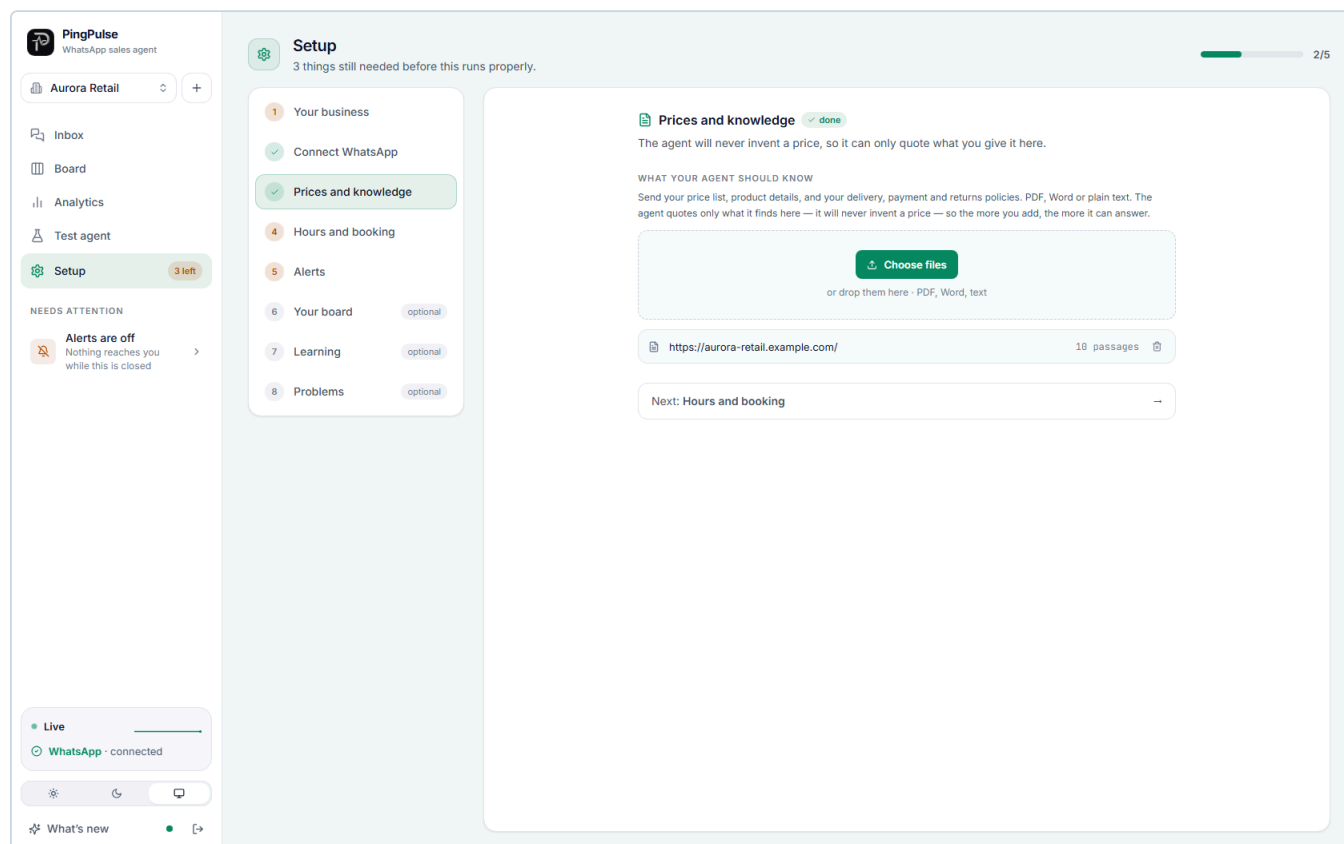
Purpose. Everything the agent says starts here. Without it, it has nothing to work from.

What you give. Your business name, what you sell, your currency, the language it replies in, and a few sentences on how it should sell.

If you skip it. The agent answers with no idea what you sell.

Worth knowing. "What you sell" is the short summary the agent reads with every reply. The full detail — the price list, the brochure — goes in **Prices and knowledge**, which it searches for each question.

Step 2 — Prices and knowledge *(required)*



Step two: upload what you already have.

Purpose. The agent will never invent a price, so it can only quote what you give it here.

What you give. The files you already have — a price list, a brochure, a product sheet, a PDF, a spreadsheet, photographs of a printed list. Upload several; they add up rather than replace each other. Prices written into "What you sell" in step one count too.

If you skip it. It has to refuse every question about cost. It will do so politely, but that is a demo, not a working agent.

Worth knowing. We show what we read back to you before it counts. If a document also states your opening hours, we offer to fill them in — as a suggestion you confirm, never as a silent change.

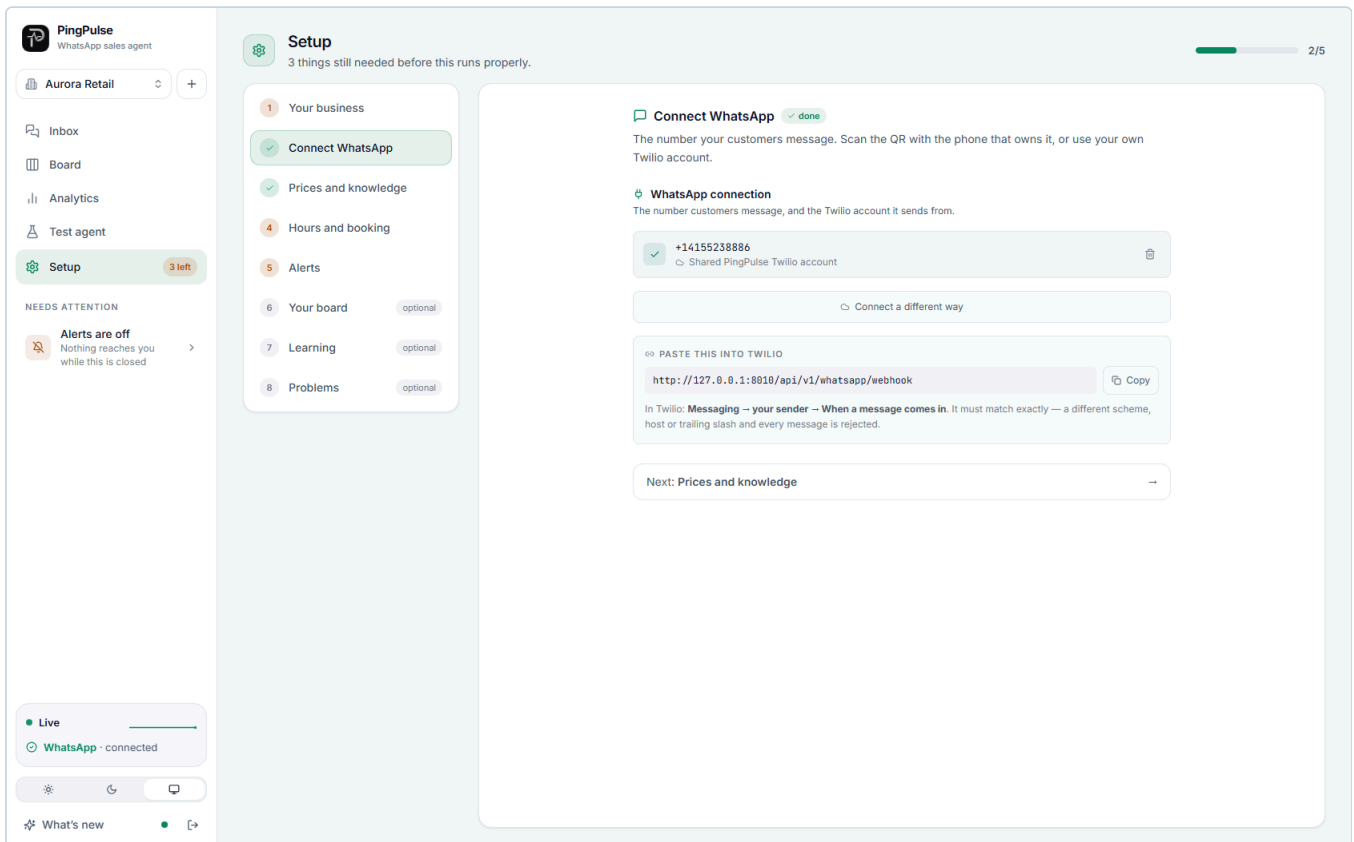
Step 3 — Where you are *(required)*

Purpose. The timezone your day is in. Every opening hour, appointment and follow-up is read against it.

What you give. Your timezone, picked from a list. The computer you are on is offered as the answer, so this is usually one click, and the current time there is shown so a wrong choice is obvious.

If you skip it. Times are read as UTC instead. The agent offers hours you are shut and books people at the wrong time. Hours cannot be saved without it either, so booking never switches on.

Step 4 – Connect WhatsApp (required)



Step four: connect the number customers already message.

Purpose. The number your customers message.

What you give. Either the phone that owns the number — scan a QR code, exactly like WhatsApp Web — or your own Twilio account details.

If you skip it. Nothing reaches you and nothing goes out. The agent is not running.

Worth knowing. If you scan the QR, keep that phone online. If WhatsApp logs the session out, the screen says so and you scan again.

Step 5 — Hours and booking (*recommended*)

The screenshot shows the PingPulse Setup interface for a WhatsApp sales agent named 'Aurora Retail'. The interface is divided into three main sections: a left sidebar, a central setup progress bar, and a main content area.

Left Sidebar:

- Top: 'Aurora Retail' with a dropdown arrow and a '+' button.
- Navigation menu: Inbox, Board, Analytics, Test agent, Setup (highlighted with a green bar and '3 left' indicator).
- NEEDS ATTENTION section: 'Alerts are off' with a subtext 'Nothing reaches you while this is closed' and a right arrow.
- Live status: 'Live' with a green progress bar, 'WhatsApp connected' with a green circle icon, and a 'What's new' button at the bottom.

Central Setup Progress Bar:

- Header: 'Setup' with a gear icon and '3 things still needed before this runs properly.'
- Progress list (1-8):
 - 1 Your business
 - 2 Connect WhatsApp
 - 3 Prices and knowledge
 - 4 Hours and booking (highlighted with a green bar)
 - 5 Alerts
 - 6 Your board (optional)
 - 7 Learning (optional)
 - 8 Problems (optional)

Main Content Area:

- Hours and booking** (checked with a green checkmark):
 - Text: 'Your timezone and opening hours. Appointments are only ever offered inside them.'
 - Warning box: 'If you skip this: Booking stays switched off, and the agent hands booking requests to you instead.'
 - How your agent should behave** (info icon):
 - Text: 'All optional. Leave it empty and nothing about your agent changes.'
 - Warning box: 'Your timezone is not set, so these hours cannot be saved yet — without one they would be read as UTC, which is how somebody gets offered an appointment in the middle of the night. Set it in Your business.'
 - Warning box: 'Your agent cannot book appointments yet. No opening hours are set, so there are no times to offer. Set them in Hours and booking. Your timezone is UTC, which is the default nobody chose. Hours cannot be saved until it is set, and every time offered is read against it. Pick it in Your business.'
- OPENING HOURS**: A table for setting hours per day.

Day	Start	End	Timezone	Status
Mon	--:-- --	to --:-- --	⊙	closed
Tue	--:-- --	to --:-- --	⊙	closed
Wed	--:-- --	to --:-- --	⊙	closed
Thu	--:-- --	to --:-- --	⊙	closed
Fri	--:-- --	to --:-- --	⊙	closed
Sat	--:-- --	to --:-- --	⊙	closed
Sun	--:-- --	to --:-- --	⊙	closed

Outside these hours it still answers — it just will not promise that somebody will call straight back.
- Appointments on your phone** (info icon):
 - Text: 'Subscribe once and every booking shows up in the calendar you already use. No account to connect, and nothing can be changed from there.'
 - Button: 'Create a calendar link'
- SERVICES YOU OFFER**: A large empty text area for listing services.
- Footer: 'One per line. It will say plainly that anything not listed is not something you do.'

Step five: opening hours per day, and whether booking can run at all.

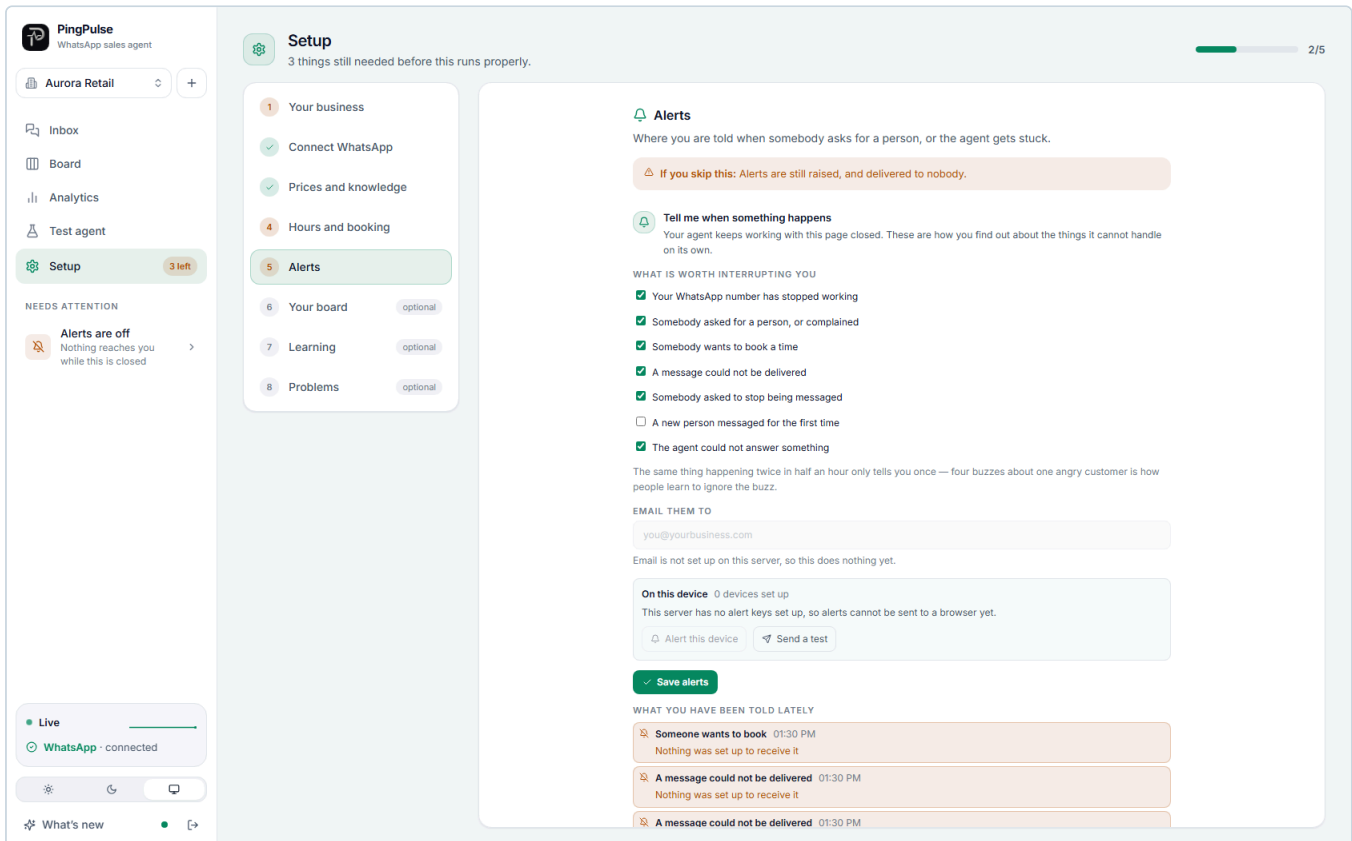
Purpose. Your opening hours. Appointments are only ever offered inside them.

What you give. Opening and closing times per day — because "9 to 5 except Saturdays, when we shut at 1" is what shops actually do, and one range cannot say it.

If you skip it. The agent cannot book anything. Every booking request is handed to a team member to arrange instead of being offered a time.

Worth knowing. This panel tells you plainly whether your agent can take an appointment at all, and what is stopping it. That message exists because a real client ran its whole life unable to book anything and nothing anywhere said so.

Step 6 — Alerts *(recommended)*



Step six: where you are told when you are needed.

Purpose. Where you are told when somebody asks for a person, or when the agent gets stuck.

What you give. An email address, notifications on this device, or both.

If you skip it. Alerts are still raised — and delivered to nobody.

Worth knowing. You can also switch on notifications for when the dashboard is closed. The panel shows what happened to recent alerts: delivered, still trying, failed, or raised with nowhere to go.

Step 7 — Calendar *(recommended)*

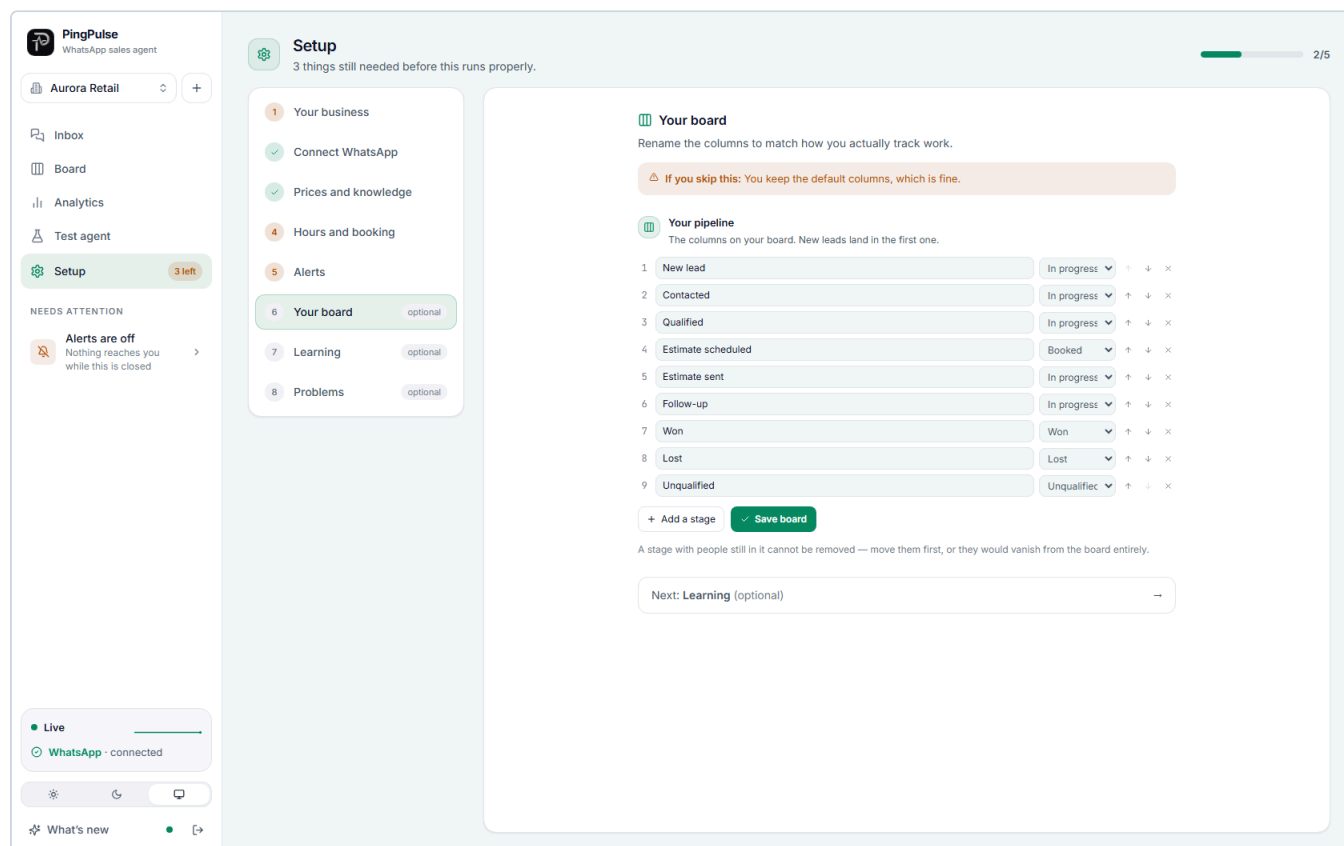
Purpose. Every booking, in the calendar you already use.

What you give. Press **Create my calendar link** and subscribe to it once from your phone's calendar — iPhone, Google Calendar or Outlook. No account to connect and nothing to install.

If you skip it. Appointments are still taken and shown in PingPulse, but nothing reaches the calendar you actually check.

Worth knowing. The feed is read-only, so nothing on your phone can change a booking by accident. Anyone with the link can see your appointments; replacing it stops every phone already subscribed.

Step 8 — Your board *(optional)*



Step eight: rename the columns to match how you actually work.

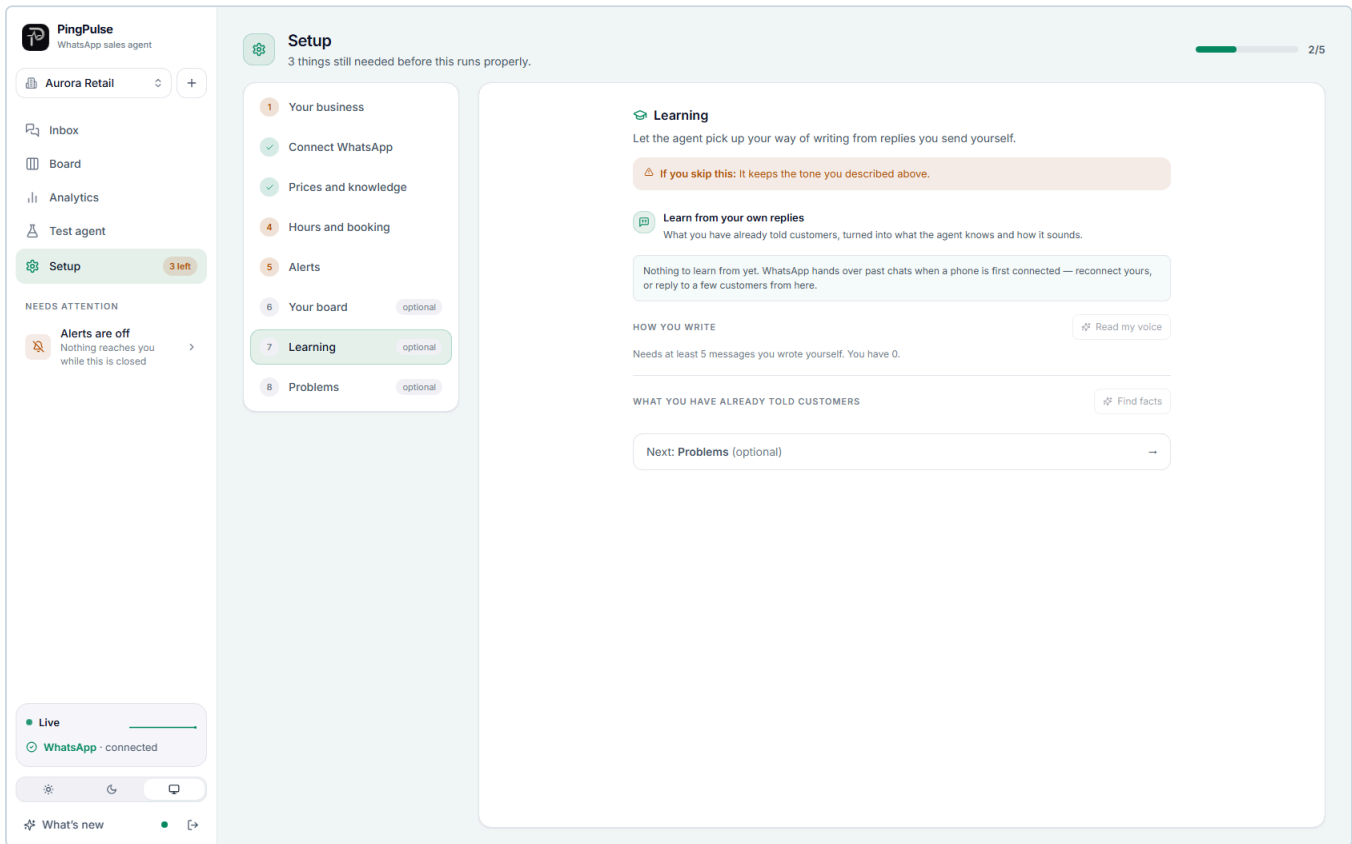
Purpose. Rename the columns to match how you actually track work.

What you give. Your own column names, in your own order. A contractor's "Estimate sent" is their whole business and means nothing to a salon.

If you skip it. You keep the default columns, which is fine.

Worth knowing. Each column says what it counts as, so the numbers on the dashboard follow whatever you call things. Deleting a column with people in it is refused, and the message tells you how many are there — the useful question is not "are you sure" but "where would those people go".

Step 9 — Learning (optional)



Step nine: let it pick up your way of writing.

Purpose. Let the agent pick up your way of writing from replies you have sent yourself.

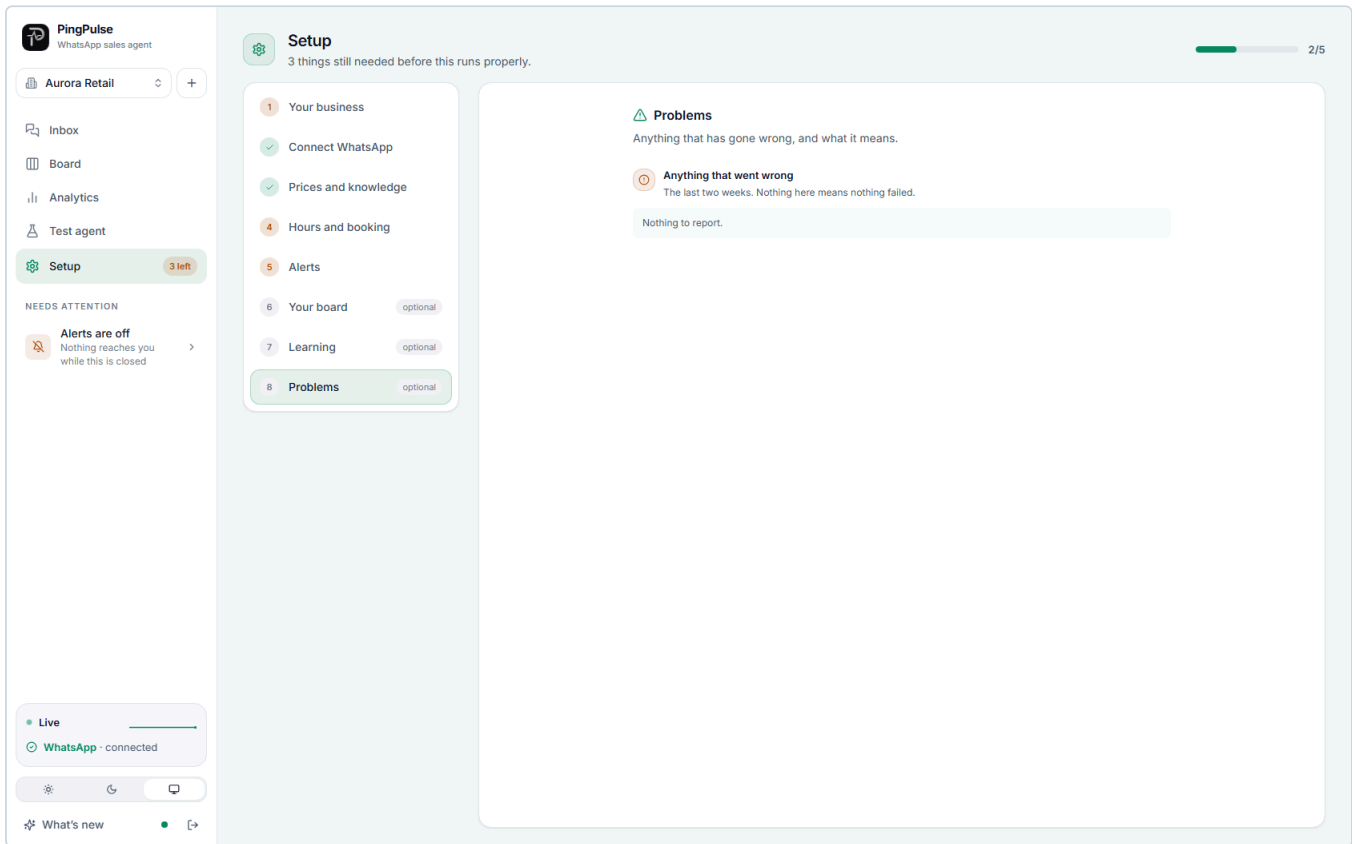
What you give. Nothing new — it reads conversations you have already had.

If you skip it. It keeps the tone you described in step one.

Worth knowing. Two separate things come out of this and the screen keeps them apart, because they fail differently.

Facts change what the agent believes and go into its knowledge. **Voice** changes how it sounds. Both are drafted, shown to you, and only applied when you press the button — and the voice is editable first, because it is your voice and you will want to correct it. It never learns from its own replies, only from yours.

Step 10 – Problems (optional)



Step ten: what has gone wrong lately, in plain words.

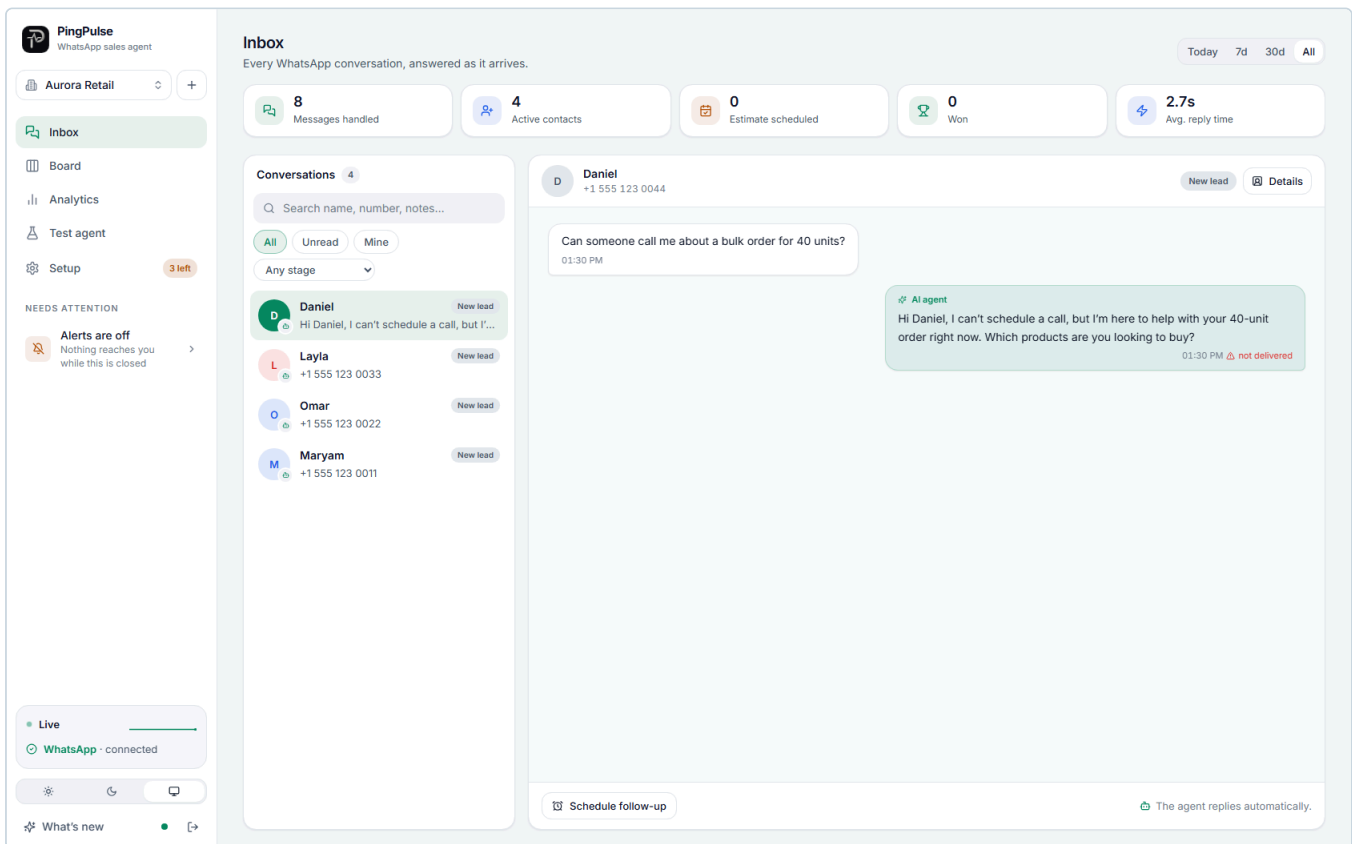
Purpose. Anything that has gone wrong, and what it means.

How you use it. Read it when something feels off. Only unresolved problems are listed; marking one done removes it, because a log that only ever grows is one nobody reads twice.

Worth knowing. The first line is written for you. The technical detail is folded away underneath, for whoever you forward it to.

6. Using it day to day

Conversations



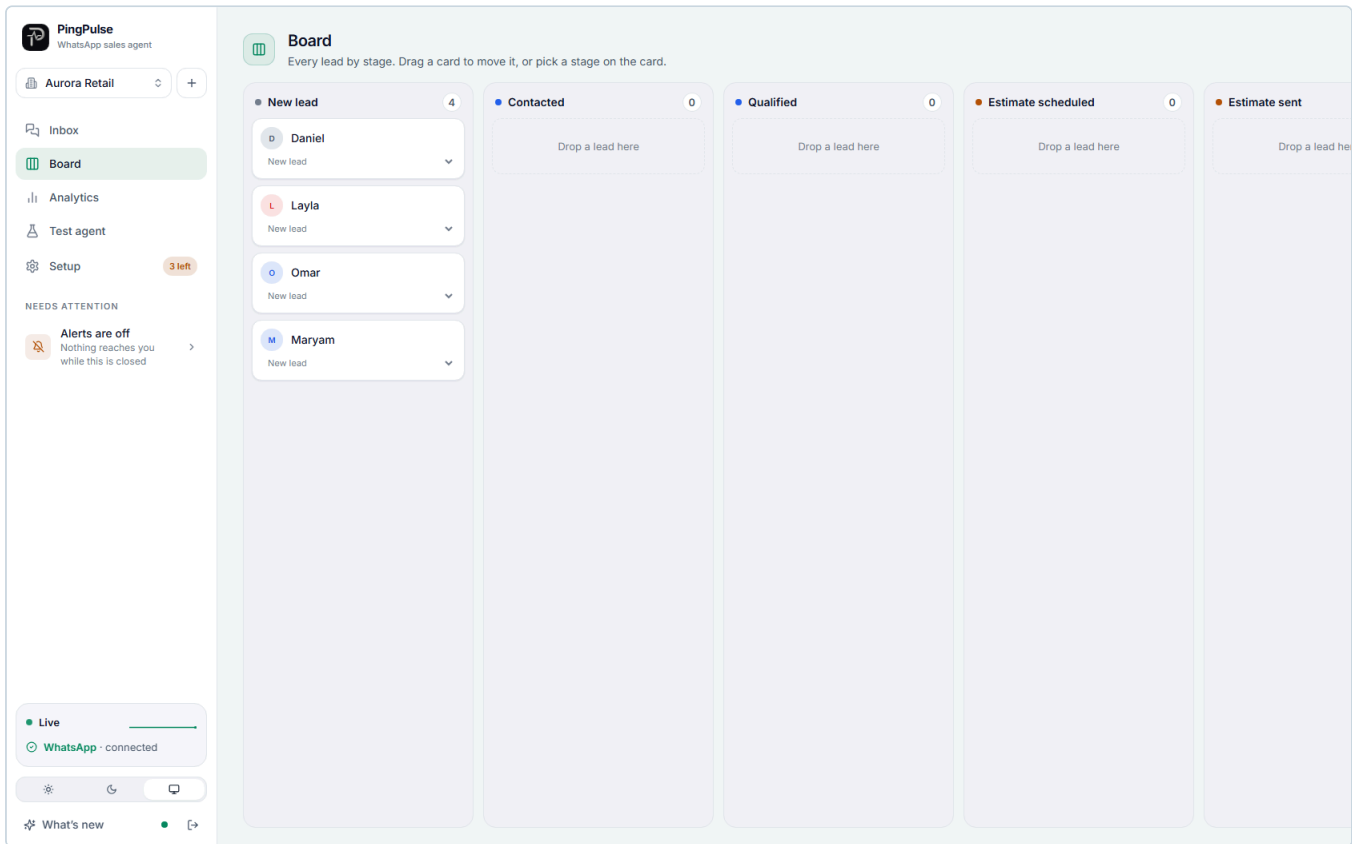
A live conversation: the customer's question, and the agent quoting a real price from a real document.

This is where most of your time goes. Every conversation is here, the agent's replies are marked as the agent's, and yours are marked as yours.

- **Take over at any time.** Open a conversation and switch the agent off for that person. It stops replying to them immediately and keeps everyone else running.
- **The lead drawer** holds what the job actually is, what it is worth and what to do next — so you do not have to read sixty messages before you can price the work.
- **Schedule a follow-up** if somebody goes quiet. You choose whether one is sent at all, and nobody is messaged at three in the morning.
- **Delivery is shown honestly.** A reply that never left the building is not marked the same as one that is waiting on a retry.

In the picture above, the customer asked for earbuds and the agent answered with two products, two real prices and two real stock counts — every one of them out of the price list that was uploaded in step two. It made up nothing, because it cannot.

The board

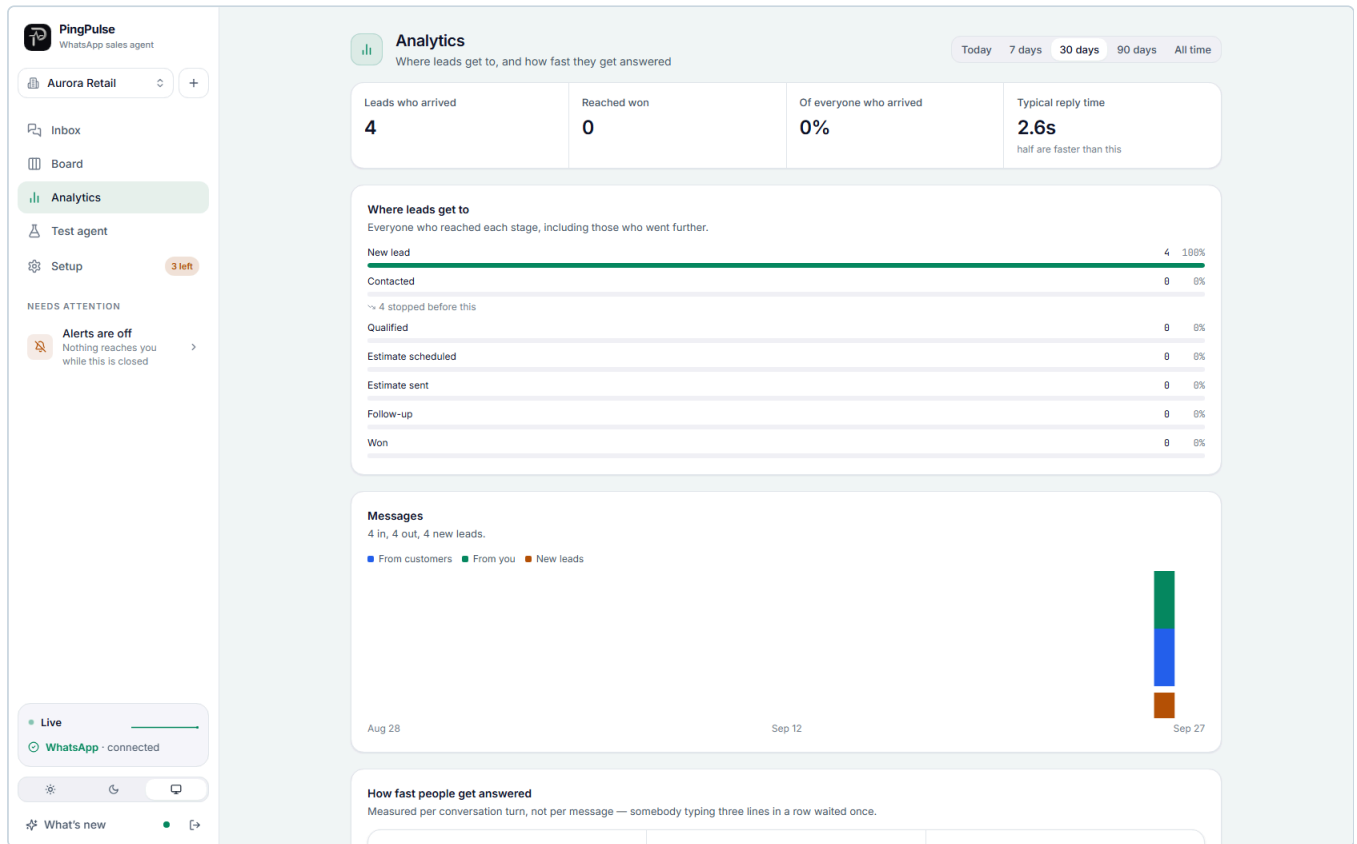


The board: every lead, in columns you named, drag to move.

The rail on the main screen answers "where does everything stand". This is the other half — columns side by side, wide enough to compare.

Drag a card to move someone, or use the menu on the card. Both work, which matters because drag-and-drop does not fire on a phone at all, and a phone is the main device for most people running this.

Analytics

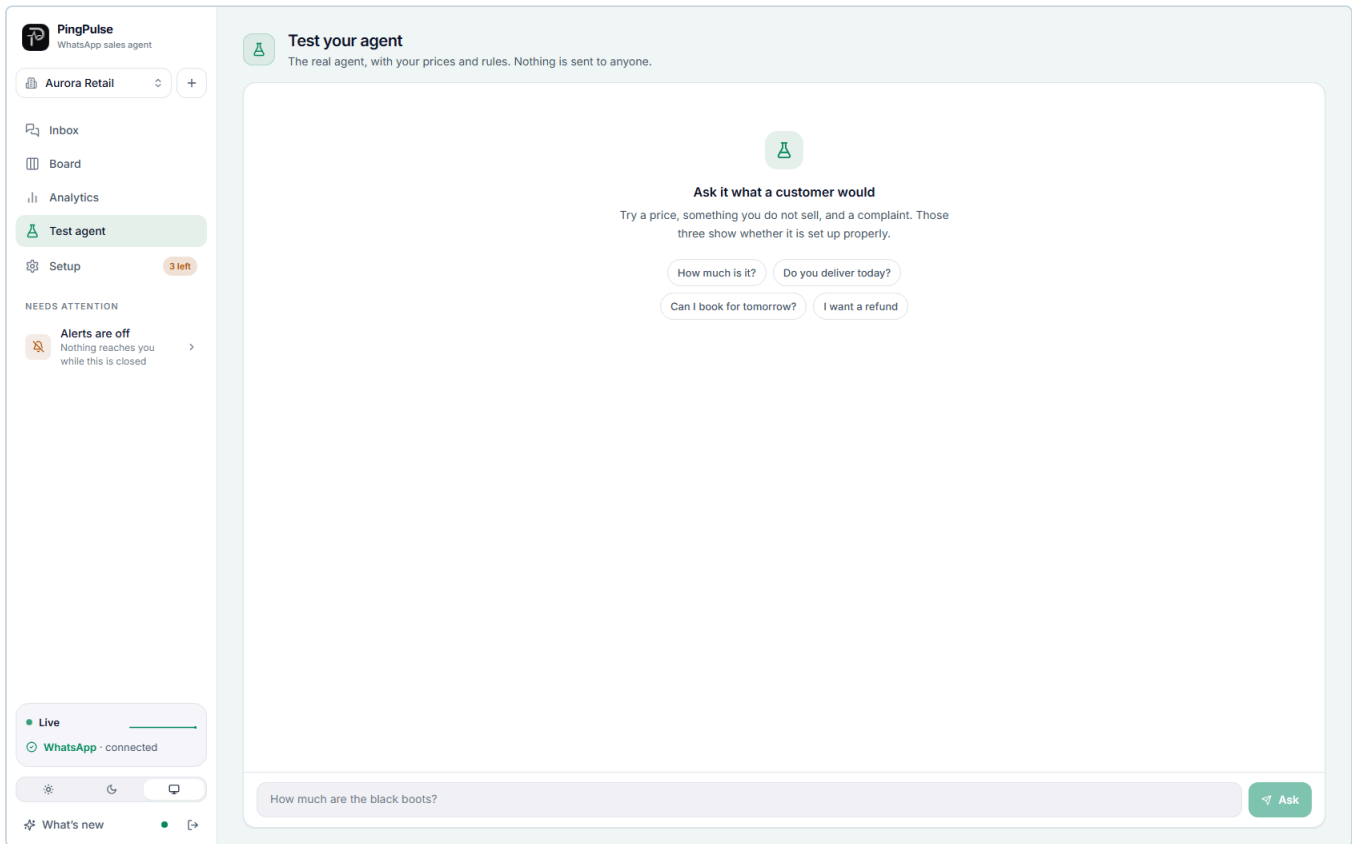


Analytics: how it is going, rather than what is happening right now.

The inbox answers what is happening now. This answers how it is going: how many got as far as qualified, where people stop replying, how fast they are answered and by whom, and how much of the pipeline has a real figure on it.

Only leads somebody has put a number against are counted in the money, and the screen says how many that is — so a total is never quietly built out of guesses.

Test agent



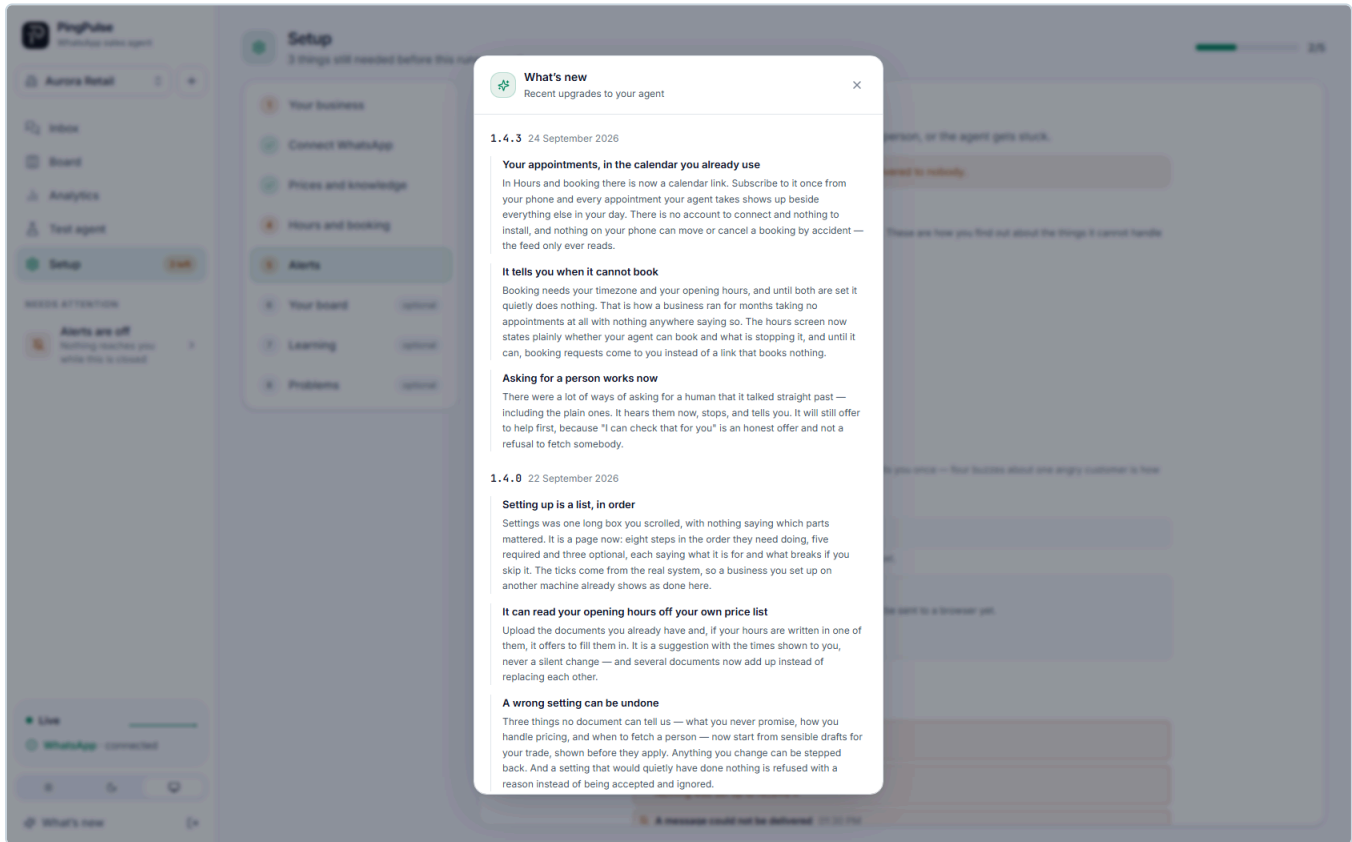
The sandbox: the real agent, with nothing sent.

Type any message and see what the agent would say. It runs the same knowledge, the same rules and the same prompt as the live one — with the sending removed. Nothing reaches a customer, and no fake lead appears on your board.

It is called **Test agent** in the sidebar. Use it after you upload a price list, after you change your hours, or whenever you want to know what it will say before it says it to somebody who matters.

If your message is one the agent would hand to a human, the sandbox shows you that rather than inventing a smooth answer. That *is* the behaviour, and hiding it would be a lie about what your agent does.

What's new



What changed, in the words of someone running a shop.

Not a changelog. Every entry is something you can see or do. The dot on the button means there is something you have not read.

7. The rules it will not break

These are enforced in the software. They are not instructions the agent can be talked out of.

- **It never says something happened unless it did.** No confirmed booking, no promised callback, no "someone will ring you in ten minutes", unless the system has actually recorded it.
- **It never invents a price.** If it is not in what you uploaded, it says it will check rather than guessing.
- **It never claims to be a person.** Asked directly, it says what it is.
- **It only offers times it can actually honour** — inside your hours, in your timezone, and only books a slot it already offered.
- **It answers each message once**, however many times the network delivers it, and sends one follow-up once.
- **It stops when somebody asks for a person**, and tells you.
- **It never messages anyone at three in the morning.**
- **It never learns from its own replies** — only from yours.

8. What we fixed recently

The honest section. These were real faults, most of them found in live accounts.

Booking that could never have worked. A client's hours had been read correctly out of a document and never confirmed, and their timezone was never set — so booking silently stayed off, and every request to book fell through to a calendar link that reached nobody. Not one appointment had ever been recorded. Now the hours panel states plainly whether booking can run and what is blocking it, and the agent hands booking requests to you rather than offering a link that books nothing.

Appointments now reach your phone. Subscribe once from your phone's calendar and every booking appears there. Read-only, no account to connect.

"Can I speak to someone?" is now heard. There were eighteen ways of asking for a human that the agent talked straight past, including the plain ones. It now recognises them and stops — while still being allowed to make an honest offer of help, which the first version of this fix wrongly blocked.

The duplicate follow-up storm. One customer received forty-four identical follow-ups in a row. Restarts during quiet hours had been stacking copies of the same reminder, all timed to release at once. A follow-up is now claimed before it is sent, so however many times the queue delivers the task, one message goes out.

Prices read out of your documents, properly. The reader was throwing away most of a price list — it discarded any line that looked like a sentence, and "Wet room conversion — from \$9,500" looks like a sentence. It also split \$9,500 into two prices. Both fixed, and documents now add up instead of replacing each other.

A wrong setting no longer breaks the agent. Three things no document can tell us — what you never promise, how you handle pricing, and when to fetch a human — are now offered as drafts for your trade, shown before they apply, and every change can be undone. Settings that would quietly do nothing are refused with a reason instead of accepted and ignored.

Quieter, safer plumbing. Some work you will never see: limits so a flood of traffic cannot take the service down, tighter checks on the two addresses open to the public, and a bound on how much configuration one account can store. None of it changes your afternoon, which is why it is at the bottom of this list.

All of this is now listed in the **What's new** panel inside the app as well, under releases 1.3.9, 1.4.0 and 1.4.3 — so you can read it where you work rather than only here.

9. If something goes wrong

1. Open **Setup** → **Problems**. Most things that break say so there, in plain words.
2. Check **Setup** → **Connect WhatsApp**. If the phone that owns the number has been logged out, nothing arrives and nothing sends.
3. Check **Setup** → **Alerts**. If alerts have nowhere to go, you will not have been told.
4. Use **Test agent** to reproduce it safely before changing anything.

If it is still wrong, send us what **Problems** shows — including the folded technical detail — and the time it happened.